

Working in Claude Code sessions

Habits that keep everything reachable — from any computer or your phone

1. Start in the cloud by default

In the desktop app's **Code** tab, before your first message, click the environment button under the message box (it says **Local**) and choose **Cloud** → **Default**.

- A cloud session keeps running with the app closed or the Mac off.
- You can open it anywhere: **claude.ai/code** in a browser, or the **Code** tab in the Claude phone app.
- Use **Local** only when the work needs files that exist only on your Mac.
- Use the **Default** cloud environment. Only add another environment if a project needs different settings (secret keys, a setup script).

2. Know the two kinds of session

Kind	Where it runs	Reachable from home?
Cloud	Anthropic's servers	Always
Local (desktop app set to Local, or <code>claude</code> typed in Terminal)	Your Mac	Only with Remote Control on, the Mac awake, and the app or terminal open

- If a session shows in your `claude.ai/code` sidebar, it is either cloud or already has Remote Control.
- A local session without Remote Control doesn't appear there at all.
- Not sure which a session is? Ask any session to check. It can look it up.

3. GitHub is the source of truth

Cloud sessions work from what's **on GitHub**, not from your Mac.

- Before switching or ending a session, say "**commit and push.**"
- Uncommitted changes stay on whichever computer made them.

4. Write things down before you stop

- **popcode-demo**: end each working session with "**save notes.**" That writes a handoff into `docs/STATUS.md`, so the next session, on any device, knows where things stand.
- **Other projects**: ask for a short handoff note committed to the repository.

5. Moving a session to the cloud

- **Desktop-app local session**: click the caret by its title (or right-click it in the sidebar), then **Open in** → **Cloud**. Commit and push first.

- **Terminal session** (started with `claude`): it can't be moved. Commit and push, save notes, then start a new cloud session on the same repository and branch and tell it to read the notes.

6. If you must use a local session while away

1. Turn on **Remote Control** in that session before you leave.
2. Keep the Mac awake: **System Settings** → **Energy** → **Prevent automatic sleeping when the display is off**, or run `caffeinate -i` in a Terminal tab.
3. Leave the app or terminal window open. Minimizing is fine; closing ends it.

Even then, a restart, a macOS update or a network drop disconnects it. That's another reason to prefer cloud.

7. One task per session, with a clear name

Short, focused sessions with descriptive titles ("Book spine fix", not "New session") are easier to find and resume. Finished sessions can be archived to keep the sidebar tidy.

End-of-day checklist

1. **"Commit and push."**
2. **"Save notes."**
3. Local and you'll want it later? **Open in** → **Cloud**.